

WORLDWISE - RERA CERTIFIED, DUBAI

Dubai Real Estate Investment Guide

2026 Edition

A practical handbook for international investors:
yields, the buying process, costs, the Golden Visa,
and how to get started.

Why International Investors Choose Dubai

Dubai is one of the world's most attractive property markets for cross-border investors. The appeal rests on durable fundamentals, not short-term hype:

- Tax efficiency: no annual property tax, no income tax on rent, and no capital gains tax on resale. Net landlord returns are materially higher than in most European or Asian markets.
- Strong rental yields: well-chosen apartments in high-demand communities typically generate gross yields around 6-9% per year.
- Residency through property: buying from AED 2 million can qualify you for a 10-year renewable Golden Visa for you and your family.
- Currency stability: the dirham is pegged to the US dollar at 3.67, removing currency risk for dollar-based investors.
- A regulated market: the Dubai Land Department (DLD) and RERA regulate transactions, and off-plan buyer funds are held in escrow.

Off-Plan vs Ready Property

The first strategic choice is off-plan (under construction) vs ready (completed, secondary market). They suit different investor profiles.

Off-plan

- Lower entry price and flexible developer payment plans (instalments across construction, sometimes post-handover).
- Strongest capital appreciation potential by handover.
- Main risk is the construction timeline - buy from a reputable developer in a strong location.

Ready / Secondary

- Rental income from day one, and you inspect exactly what you buy.
- Higher upfront cost; paid in full or via mortgage at transfer.
- Lower timeline risk - ideal for income-focused investors.

The Buying Process, Step by Step

1. Define your goal

Income, capital growth, or residency? This drives area, unit type and off-plan vs ready.

2. Work with a RERA-registered agent

Verify the broker's BRN. A good agent shows comparable transactions and is honest about the developer's track record.

3. Reserve and sign

Pay a reservation fee, then sign the SPA (off-plan) or MOU / Form F (resale). Have the contract reviewed.

4. Register with the DLD

Ownership is protected only once registered. The DLD charges a 4% transfer fee; off-plan registers via an interim Oqood until handover.

5. Handover and setup

On completion, inspect (snagging), take the title deed, then set up utilities (DEWA) and a tenancy (Ejari) if renting out.

Costs to Budget For

Beyond the price, budget roughly 6-7% of the purchase price for transaction costs (cash purchase):

- DLD transfer fee: 4% of the purchase price (the largest single cost).
- Registration trustee fee: AED 2,000-4,000 + 5% VAT.
- Title deed issuance and admin: a few hundred AED.
- Agent commission: typically around 2% + VAT.
- If financing: mortgage registration 0.25% of the loan, plus bank arrangement and valuation fees.

There are no annual property taxes after purchase - the DLD fee is a one-time cost at transfer.

The Golden Visa

For many buyers, residency matters as much as returns. Owning Dubai property from AED 2 million can make you eligible for a 10-year renewable UAE Golden Visa.

- Covers you and your family (spouse and children).
- No local sponsor required; long-term stability for living, schooling and business.
- Available on ready and qualifying off-plan property meeting the threshold.

Worldwise can shortlist Golden-Visa-eligible properties that also make sense as investments - just ask for the current list.

Ready to Invest in Dubai Real Estate?

Get a free, no-obligation consultation with our
RERA-certified advisors. We match you with handpicked
off-plan and ready investments.

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